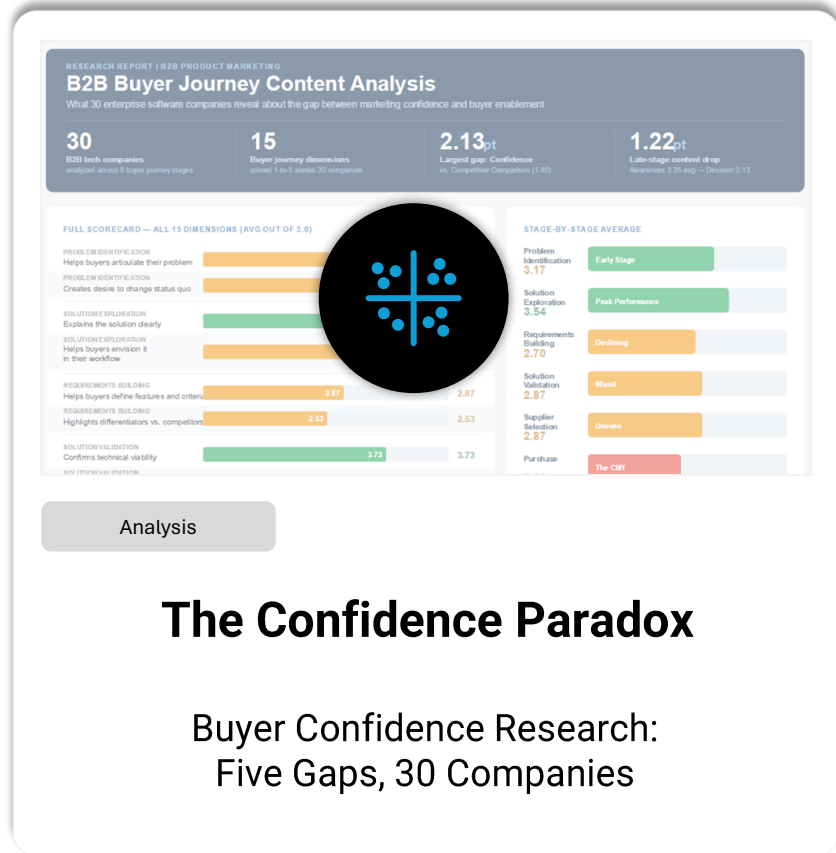




Situation: Liaison Creative was conducting buyer impact analyses for B2B tech clients, evaluating how well their content supported buyers at each stage of the purchase journey. Across engagements, patterns began repeating. Rather than treat each client as a one-off problem, Liaison systematized what they were seeing into primary research. They scored 30 enterprise software companies across 15 buyer journey dimensions to establish a baseline for the industry.

Complication: The data exposed a structural failure hiding in plain sight. Vendor credibility content scored 3.93. Competitive comparison content scored 1.80. The 2.13-point gap was not a resource problem. It was a deliberate choice that happened to work against the vendor at the moment it mattered most. Content investment dropped 1.22 points from awareness to decision stage, exactly when buyers needed help building internal consensus, justifying ROI, and surviving procurement. The average B2B purchase involves six to ten stakeholders. Almost none of the content reviewed was written for more than one of them. Sales was filling that gap manually, deal by deal, at significant cost and inconsistent quality.

Resolution: Liaison used the research to build a portfolio of strategic services designed to close the gaps the data identified. Fast-relief deliverables targeted the highest-scoring gaps first: competitive comparison content, late-stage consensus tools, and ungated technical validation. Those initial engagements created the proof of value that converted into ongoing retainer relationships or embedded Liaison resources working on-site with the client's marketing team.

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- The Confidence Paradox** — Vendor credibility is the top score (3.93). Competitive comparison is the bottom (1.80). Companies have opted out of the one conversation buyers need most before signing.
- The Late-Stage Cliff** — Early-stage content averages 3.35. Decision-stage content averages 2.13. Content is built for traffic and MQLs. Buyers who are ready to buy get handed off to sales with no self-serve support.
- Demo Access Is a Deliberate Gate** — Technical validation scores 3.73. Demo access scores 2.00. The "talk to sales first" gate forces qualification. Buyers experience it as friction.
- Companies Explain. They Cannot Differentiate.** — Solution explanation scores 3.87. Competitive differentiation scores 2.53. Most B2B sites describe what they do. Almost none explain why they win. Positioning requires comparison.
- The Buying Committee Blindspot** — Consensus and onboarding content both score 2.33. The average B2B purchase involves 6 to 10 stakeholders. Content is written for one reader. Sales fills this gap manually for every deal. That does not scale.